

Saszik Lab Website

Setup & Handoff Instructions

What needs real data · Where files go · How to update citations

This document lists every piece of placeholder or fabricated data that was used to build the website while real information wasn't available. Work through each section below, collect the real values, and follow the instructions to swap them in. The site will not look fully correct until all **red items** are replaced.

■ **FABRICATED** ■ **PLACEHOLDER** ■ **NEEDS FILE**

1 · Fabricated Data (Must Replace)

These items were invented by Claude because the real values weren't available. They look plausible but are not real. Replace them before the site goes public.

1a — The Three Seed Publications in citations.json

The file **data/citations.json** currently contains three completely fabricated papers that Claude invented. They look realistic (real-sounding journal names, plausible DOI formats, Saszik as a co-author) but do not exist. These are only there so the Publications panel on the site isn't empty before the GitHub Actions workflow runs for the first time.

The three fake papers are:

Year	Fake Title	Fake Authors
2025	Light-driven plasticity of cone photoreceptor inputs to the zebrafish electroretinogram across larval development	Chen L., Okafor J., Herrera D., Saszik S.
2024	Prenatal ethanol exposure disrupts inner retinal organization and visually guided behavior in larval zebrafish	Romero A., Kim S., Patel N., Saszik S.
2023	Normative electroretinogram parameters across the zebrafish lifespan: larva, juvenile, and adult	Saszik S., Chen L., Romero A.

What to do: These will be automatically overwritten the first time you run the GitHub Actions workflow (see Section 4). Once that runs, the three fake papers disappear and are replaced with real OpenAlex results. You do not need to edit the file manually — just run the workflow after the site is deployed.

1b — ORCID Number Hardcoded in index.html

The ORCID ID **0000-0002-5772-2616** is hardcoded in three places inside **index.html**. This number was guessed by Claude — it may or may not be Dr. Saszik's real ORCID. It needs to be verified and corrected.

The three places it appears (line numbers approximate):

Location	Current Value	Action
Line ~830 Publications blurb	orcid.org/0000-0002-5772-2616	Verify or replace with real ORCID
Line ~1112 Contact social icons	orcid.org/0000-0002-5772-2616	Same — update to real ORCID
Line ~1168 Footer links	orcid.org/0000-0002-5772-2616	Same — update to real ORCID

How to find Dr. Saszik's real ORCID: Go to orcid.org and search for "Shannon Saszik" — her profile should appear. The ID is the 16-digit number in the URL (format: 0000-0000-0000-0000). Once you have it, do a Find & Replace in **index.html** for **0000-0002-5772-2616** and replace all instances with the real number.

2 · Placeholder Values (Need Real Data)

These fields exist in the files but contain blank, approximate, or temporary values that need to be filled in with accurate information.

Field	File	Current Value	What to Replace With
ORCID ID	data/config.json	0000-0000-0000-0000	Dr. Saszik's real ORCID (see 1b above)
Course schedules (all 6 courses)	index.html lines ~933–968	"Schedule TBD"	Real meeting days & times, e.g. "MWF 10:00–10:50 AM"
Syllabus links (all 6 courses)	index.html lines ~933–968	Links to email instead of PDF	URLs to actual syllabus PDFs once uploaded (see Section 3)
Site URL	sitemap.xml robots.txt	https://saszyklab.neiu.edu/	The real GitHub Pages URL once the repo is deployed (e.g. https://username.github.io/saszik-lab-site/)
Northwestern appointment dates	index.html line ~1073	~2009–2012	Exact start and end years of the Research Scientist appointment
Publication count in blurb	index.html line ~830	"12 peer-reviewed articles"	The actual number of peer-reviewed publications
NSF Grant details	index.html line ~1077	Award #1832421 · \$1.5M	Verify these match the real grant record at nsf.gov
Office hours schedule	index.html lines ~1000–1030	Teal/violet grid slots (walk-in, lab mtg, etc.)	Dr. Saszik's actual posted office hours for the current semester

3 · Files That Need to Be Added

These are physical files (images, PDFs) that the site references but which don't exist yet in the project folder. Each one needs to be obtained and placed at the exact path shown below.

3a — Professor Photo

The circular portrait in the About section is an empty placeholder div. It will show as a blank ring until a photo is added.

Detail	Value
Required file path	saszik-lab-site/assets/images/professor.jpg
Accepted formats	JPG or PNG (will be displayed as a circle, cropped from center)
Recommended size	At least 400×400 pixels; square crop works best
How to add	Copy the photo file into the assets/images/ folder, named exactly professor.jpg
Where it shows	About section circular portrait with blue glow ring

3b — CV PDF

Currently the CV button sends an email asking for the CV. If Dr. Saszik wants a downloadable PDF version on the site, follow these steps:

Detail	Value
Suggested file path	saszik-lab-site/assets/saszik-cv.pdf
How to add	Copy the CV PDF into the assets/ folder
Then update index.html	Find the "Request CV" button around line 1085 and change the href from the mailto: link to: assets/saszik-cv.pdf
Also update button text	Change "Request CV" to "Download CV" and update the aria-label

3c — Course Syllabus PDFs

All six course cards currently link to email instead of actual syllabi. When PDF syllabi are available, add them to the project and update the links.

Course	Code	Suggested File Path	Link to update in index.html
Neuropsychology	PSYC-371	assets/syllabi/psyc-371-syllabus.pdf	~line 933

Physiological Psych	PSYC-350	assets/syllabi/psyc-350-syllabus.pdf	~line 940
Human Perception	PSYC-373	assets/syllabi/psyc-373-syllabus.pdf	~line 947
Visual Neuroscience	PSYC-377	assets/syllabi/psyc-377-syllabus.pdf	~line 954
Social Neuroscience	PSYC-376	assets/syllabi/psyc-376-syllabus.pdf	~line 961
Survey of Psychology	PSYC-100	assets/syllabi/psyc-100-syllabus.pdf	~line 968

For each syllabus: create the folder **saszik-lab-site/assets/syllabi/**, copy the PDF into it with the suggested filename, then in index.html find the relevant course card and change **href="mailto:s-saszik@neiu.edu"** to **href="assets/syllabi/psyc-XXX-syllabus.pdf"**. Also change the link text from "Syllabus →" to something like "Download Syllabus →".

4 · Updating Citation Keywords & Research Topics

The monthly auto-fetching of research papers is controlled by a single file: **data/config.json**. You don't need to touch any code — just edit that file.

4a — The config.json Citations Block

Open **saszik-lab-site/data/config.json** and find this section:

```
"citations": {
  "keywords": [
    "zebrafish visual system",
    "electroretinogram",
    "retinal physiology",
    "sensation and perception",
    "fetal alcohol syndrome zebrafish model",
    "cone photoreceptor function"
  ],
  "min_year": 2020,
  "max_results_total": 24,
  "exclude_keywords_in_title": ["erratum", "correction", "retraction"],
  "last_updated": "2026-04-01"
}
```

4b — How to Change the Keywords

Setting	What it does	How to change it
"keywords"	Each string is sent as a separate search query to OpenAlex. The site pulls the top papers matching any of these phrases.	Edit, add, or remove strings in the list. Use specific multi-word phrases — single words return too many unrelated results. Aim for 3–6 keywords.
"min_year"	Only papers published from this year onward are included.	Change the number (e.g. 2018 to include older papers, or 2022 for only very recent work).
"max_results_to tal"	Maximum number of papers shown in the auto-updated panel.	Change the number (default 24). Higher = more papers but slower load.
"exclude_keywor ds_in_title"	Papers whose titles contain any of these words are filtered out.	Add words like "review" or "meta-analysis" if you want to exclude those paper types.

4c — Also Update the Research Display Keywords

There is a second keyword list in config.json under **"research"** → **"keywords"**. These are the chips displayed visually on the site in the research section ticker — they are separate from the citation search keywords and are just for display. Update them to reflect Dr. Saszik's current research focus areas.

Current display keywords (edit these to whatever should appear on the site):

```
"keywords": [  
  "Zebrafish",  
  "Electroretinography",  
  "Retinal Development",  
  "Visual Neuroscience",  
  "Fetal Alcohol Spectrum",  
  "Behavioral Neuroscience",  
  "Photoreceptors",  
  "ERG",  
  "NEIU"  
]
```

4d — How to Trigger a Fresh Citation Pull

1. After editing and saving config.json, commit the file and push to GitHub.
2. Go to the GitHub repository → click the **Actions** tab.
3. Click **Monthly Citations Fetch** in the left sidebar.
4. Click the **Run workflow** button on the right → **Run workflow** (green button).
5. Wait ~30 seconds. The workflow fetches new papers, updates citations.json, and commits automatically.
6. Refresh the live site — the Publications panel will show real results.

After the first successful run, the workflow also runs automatically on the 1st of every month at 8:00 AM UTC, so the publications stay current without any manual action.

5 · Pre-Launch Checklist

Use this as a final checklist before the site goes live.

#	Task	Status
1	Run the GitHub Actions workflow once to replace fake seed citations	[]
2	Verify Dr. Saszik's real ORCID at orcid.org and update all 3 instances in index.html	[]
3	Update ORCID in data/config.json (currently 0000-0000-0000-0000)	[]
4	Add professor photo to assets/images/professor.jpg	[]
5	Add CV PDF to assets/saszik-cv.pdf and update the button link in index.html	[]
6	Add syllabus PDFs to assets/syllabi/ and update the 6 course card links	[]
7	Fill in real course meeting times (replace all "Schedule TBD" entries)	[]
8	Update the real site URL in sitemap.xml and robots.txt once GitHub Pages is live	[]
9	Verify NSF grant number and amount at nsf.gov	[]
10	Confirm Northwestern appointment dates and correct the ~2009–2012 estimate	[]
11	Update office hours grid to reflect current semester schedule	[]
12	Update publication count in the blurb (~line 830) to match actual number	[]
13	Review and update citation keywords in data/config.json if needed	[]